NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



The Garland Girl

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

The Garland Girl

She wove a flower for everyone but herself.

She grew up in a house full of drying herbs. Her father hung them from every beam, and in the evenings he taught her their names: rosemary for remembering, pansies for thoughts, fennel and columbine, rue for sorrow, and the daisy that is only for those who are loved. By the time she could walk to the brook alone she could weave any of them into a garland, and she made one for everyone she loved.

A young man came to the house who spoke the way songs do. He promised her things in the garden, and she believed every word, and wove him a garland of violets. Then her father died, suddenly, in a dark corridor, and the young man looked at her in front of everyone as though he had never seen her before. He pretended not to know her. That was worse than anything he could have said.

After that she sang. She sang the old songs, half of them wrong, and went through the house giving her flowers away: rosemary to her brother, fennel to the king, rue to the queen and a little for herself. One afternoon she went down to the willow that leaned over the brook, to hang the last of her garlands on its branches. The branch broke. Her dress spread out on the water and held her up a while, and she went on singing, as if she did not understand what was happening, until the water grew too heavy.

Everyone remembered her flowers. No one ever asked which one she had kept for herself. The old ferryman would not carry her; there was no coin under her tongue, only a petal. So she waits with you, still singing, her hands full of wet flowers.



What the Ferrymen know

She has always understood the Book better than anyone; she lived by the meanings of things. Her pages are blessed when only three memories are written there, for she never needed many words to say what she meant.

Twist: Each page gives its Chapter Blessing at only 3 inscribed memories.

Key Memory: *the one flower I kept for myself*



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach: page I, *Who I Was* (Reach I); page II, *What I Did* (Reach II); page III, *What I Carry* (Reach III). Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which complete a sentence about the soul's life.

Inscribing. When a card Resonates, you may inscribe it if the slot shown on the card is still empty on the page of the Reach the soul is in. A **Key Memory** may be inscribed whenever it is played face up, Resonating or not. To inscribe, put the card in its slot with photo corners instead of discarding it; it stays there for the rest of the game. Oblivion cards and Burned cards cannot be inscribed.

Page rewards. Each page pays a small reward for each pair of neighbouring slots: **Place + Person**, **Person + Deed** and **Deed + Feeling**. When an inscription fills the second slot of a pair, do that pair's reward at once. One card can complete two pairs (a Person inscribed next to a Place and a Deed): do both. Each reward happens once per page; tick its box in the Book. The rewards are printed on each page:

Chapter Blessing. When all 4 slots of a page are filled (3 for the Garland Girl), the page also gives one Chapter Blessing at once (only once per page). The Blessing is not chosen. Check these in order and do the first one that is possible:

If the soul has at least one Fracture: remove 1 Fracture (from the highest well).

Otherwise, if any space has Black Water: remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul from the game.

Otherwise, if the forgotten pile has any cards: move the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

Otherwise nothing happens.

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners into the photo corners. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...



I loved...



I once...



and ever since I have carried...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Place 1 Root.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Bloom 1 Root.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Gain 2 Light.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐☐☐

II · What I Did

At...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ PLACE + PERSON
Banish the nearest Shade.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Drain the nearest Black Water.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Mend 1 Fracture.

☐ DEED + FEELING
The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: the soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **In the forgotten pile**: the soul crosses without it, lighter and emptier.
- ☐ **Anywhere else** (deck, a hand or the discard pile): it was never spoken, and the soul crosses with it unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page, even after a loss. Empty slots are read as "...but this, the river has taken".

FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____



NETHERBLOOM

RALPH LAUXIE